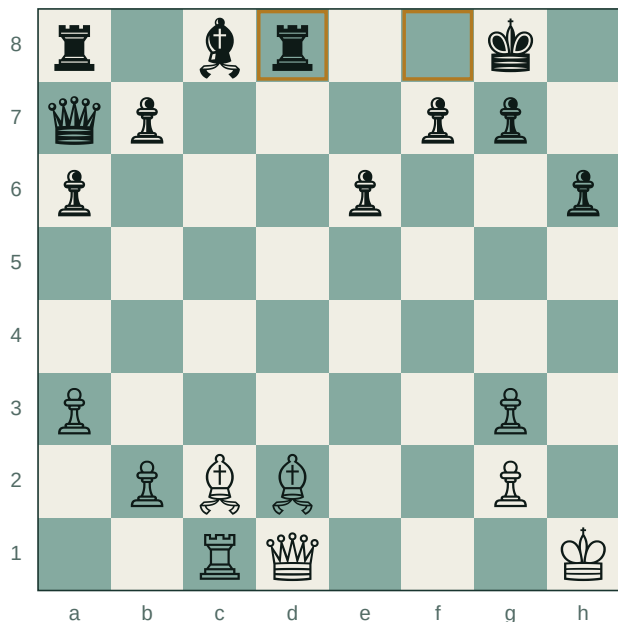


# Calculated sacrifices: White, move 22

Calculated sacrifices

White to move



Previous move: 21...Rd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**22. Be3 Rxd1+ 23. Rxd1 Kf8 24. Bxa7 Rxa7 25. Rd8+ Ke7 26. Rxc8**

**22.Be3** The bishop moves from d2 to e3. The changed line means the queen on d1 attacks the rook on d8. Recorded reply: **22...Rxd1+**.

**23.Rxd1** The rook captures the rook on d1. Recorded reply: **23...Kf8**.

**24.Bxa7** The bishop captures the queen on a7. Recorded reply: **24...Rxa7**.

**25.Rd8+** Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. From d8 it attacks king on f8 and bishop on c8. Recorded reply: **25...Ke7**.

**26.Rxc8** The rook captures the bishop on c8.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 11 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +5:** the balance goes from -4 to +1. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

An attractive attacking picture is not compensation by itself. Continue until the resulting position can be evaluated honestly.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

A sacrifice exchanges material for a concrete benefit. The benefit may be mate, a stronger attack, a recovered investment, or lasting activity; it must be shown through moves.

**HOW TO LOOK**

State what the sacrifice changes: a defender, a line, a king square, or a critical tempo. Calculate acceptance and plausible refusal.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on d8. Check for tactical protection.